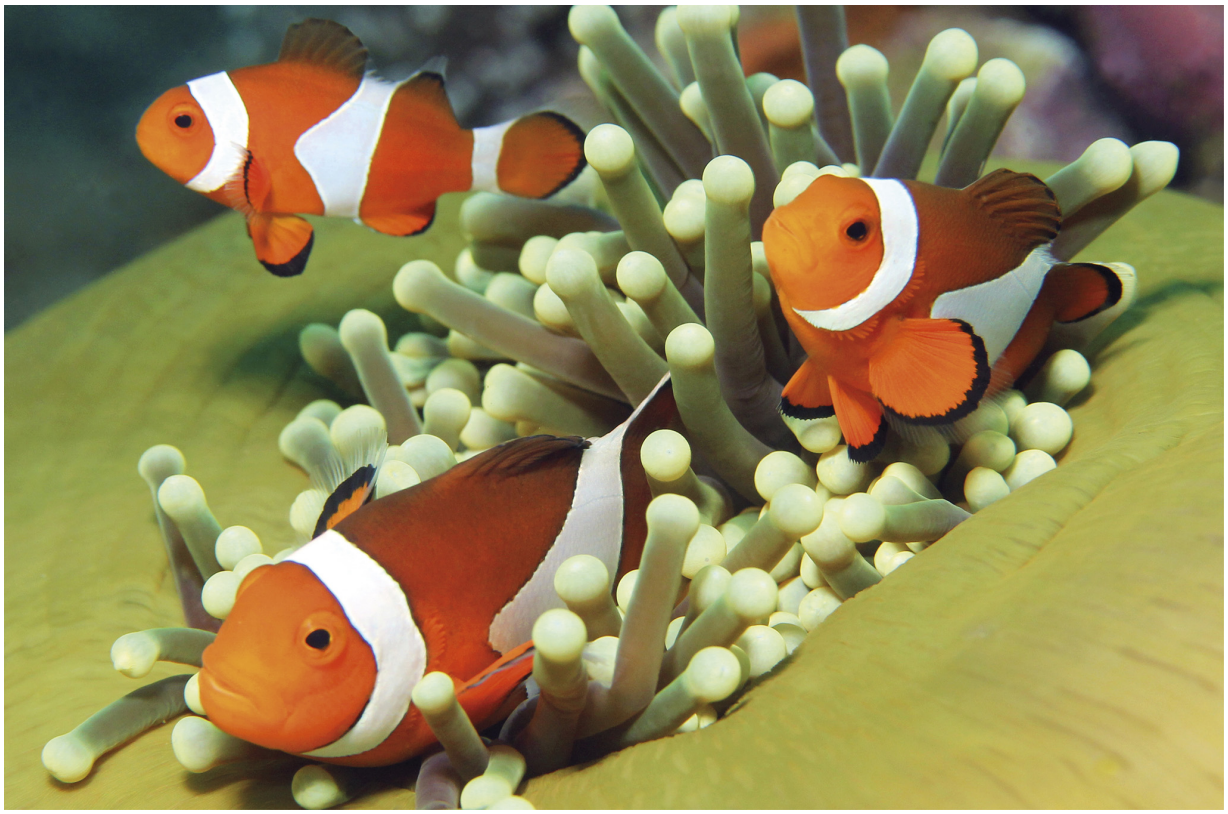


The clownfish and sea anemone could both survive without the other's protection, but their coevolved mutual relationship gives them a much higher chance of survival.

"There is mutual aid in many species."

Pierre-Joseph van Beneden

Belgian zoologist

Cooperative evolution

Relationships between service and resource providers have developed over millions of years in a process called "coevolution"—the evolution of two or more species that affect each other reciprocally.

The term coevolution was coined by American biologists Paul Ehrlich and Peter Raven in 1964, but a century before the word existed, the naturalists Charles Darwin and Alfred Russel Wallace were already aware